in senior positions in the NLD have worked out that the only possible end point to the complete separation of the Rohingyas from civil society is mass murder or forced removal. If the party cannot support this then it may have to accept that the current level of persecution needs to be eased. Again, international pressure may be important in this regard.

The more those who do not share the extremists' ideology are forced to think about its inevitable consequences, the more likely it is they will have to stop being complicit. This is important, because as we have discussed earlier, there is an authoritarian and discriminatory element to Theravada Buddhism. This is not unique to that belief system, and is a significant problem for many of the world's contemporary religions. However, other faiths are having to find ways to challenge their own extremists, and it is important this also takes place within Myanmar.

Conclusions

Despite the grim situation there is much that can be done, both domestically and internationally, to help the Rohingyas and hopefully avoid a genocide—but a real will to take action is needed, rather than the continuation of 'business as usual' in the hope that nothing actually happens in Rakhine to make us complicit through inaction in a repeat of the genocide in Rwanda. Practically, this involves creating a minimum set of demands and seeking to hold the Myanmar authorities to them. Some international bodies, such as ASEAN, are already creating pressure, as they are suffering directly from the consequences of the persecution of the Rohingyas. It is not enough for foreign powers to hide behind the ready belief that nothing they can say or do will influence the regime. In this, the lesson from Rwanda is clear: international silence will be interpreted as international disinterest—removing one of the few barriers now standing between the Rohingyas and genocide.